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Submitter Information

Name: Scott Tuffiash

[REDACTED] pa.us

General Comment

My name is Scott Tuffiash and I am a high school Language Arts and Journalism teacher at Avonworth High School in Pittsburgh. I currently teach a new course for this school, and it seems maybe a new course for almost any public school, titled "Human Flourishing" and I completed teaching another new course last semester for high school seniors titled "AI and Ethics". Because of this phrase matching the Human Flourishing course I currently teach -" With the right governmental policies, continued U.S. AI leadership will promote human flourishing, economic competitiveness, and national security.", and because I have studied viewpoints on innovation and regulation regarding Artificial Intelligence products to create the AI and Ethics class and then teach it, I am submitting comments myself and asking about 50 students from this school to do the same today and tomorrow.

Less regulation - through Executive Order 14179 - will allow further experimentation of AI products in the free market of US consumers. What is the current potency of AI products and how can they impact a consumer? At its best, an AI product can offer mathematically derived insights that offer a consumer a variety of outputs. Improved productivity at a job, more efficient use of professional and personal time, potentially improved sense of well-being or purpose: these are potential benefits of a less regulated market of products.

Unfortunately, less regulation places the burden of ethical innovation on the consumer instead of the producer. What is at stake then? In the worst case scenario, the mental wellbeing of the consumer. . .and then potentially the physical life of the consumer itself. Consider <https://techcrunch.com/2024/10/23/lawsuit-blames-character-ai-in-death-of-14-year-old-boy/>. Vice President Vance suggested at the AI Summit in France that products targeting minors are going to be regulated. But what about the same exact impact of a product built with effective addictive design, unregulated, for a 19 year old? Is the human brain that much more developed at 19 compared to 14? How do we prove that distinction between 14 and 19, reliably, scientifically? Without the onus of regulation on for-profit companies to transparently display addictive design qualities, and furthermore legal ramifications for companies to suffer significant financial losses if they promote addictive design products and can legally hide the design, innovation becomes secondary to a damaged free market of consumers of all ages. Rather than a complete removal of content like the AI Bill of Rights from the prior administration, there should be a re-opening, however swift, for more transparent sharing of information, debate, and policy change within this Presidency, like President Trump's White House website from his first term of office: <https://trumpwhitehouse.archives.gov/ai/ai-american-innovation/>